IEEE YP Sri Lanka & IEEE StudPro 9.0

Mentoring Meet Program – Event Proposal

IEEE StudPro 9.0 | Hybrid Mentoring Podcast Series

At a Glance

Organizing Bodies: IEEE YPSL & IEEE StudPro 9.0

Program Format: Hybrid Mentoring Podcast Series

Total Sessions: 6 Domain-Focused Sessions

Mentees per Session: 40 (Physical + Virtual)

Total Mentees Reached: 240 (40 × 6 Sessions)

Mentors per Session: 3 (2 Industry + 1 Academic)

International Participation: Mentors & Mentees via Online Platforms

Funding Requested: Up to USD 1,500 (IEEE MM Program)

1. Executive Summary

IEEE StudPro 9.0 Mentoring Meet is a flagship, multi-session mentoring initiative jointly organized by IEEE Young Professionals Sri Lanka (YPSL) and IEEE StudPro 9.0. The program is designed to empower undergraduate students by connecting them with distinguished professionals from industry and academia across IT, Engineering, and Business domains.

The program is structured as a Hybrid Mentoring Podcast Series — a dynamic, broadcast-style mentoring format delivered across six domain-specific sessions. Each session brings together three mentors (two industry practitioners and one academic expert) and 40 mentees in a structured, interactive environment. Sessions are designed to be simultaneously accessible to local attendees in person and to international participants joining via online platforms, ensuring broad geographic reach and diversity.

A key feature of this initiative is the inclusion of international mentors and mentees, directly fulfilling a core requirement of the IEEE Mentoring Meet (MM) Program's cross-border participation criterion. Sessions 1 through 4 are hosted at the premises of industry partner organizations, creating an immersive real-world environment. Following the formal session, a dedicated 2-hour one-on-one industry mentoring window allows mentees to engage directly with mentors for personalized career guidance. Sessions 5 and 6 adopt a full hybrid broadcast model, hosted from a professional studio facility equipped with AR/VR technology, live-streamed on YouTube, and delivered concurrently via Zoom for international virtual attendees.

By the conclusion of the program, a total of 240 mentees (40 per session × 6 sessions) will have directly benefited from structured, high-impact mentoring interactions.

Alignment with IEEE MM Program Objectives
• Diverse mentor panel: industry, academia, and entrepreneurship represented across all sessions
• Cross-border participation: international mentors and mentees integrated via virtual platforms
• Hybrid delivery model: physical and virtual participation in every session
• 1-on-1 mentoring: dedicated post-session engagement beyond panel discussions
• Feedback and reporting: official MM registration forms and vTools reporting (#mentoringmeet)

2. Program Objectives

The IEEE StudPro 9.0 Mentoring Meet is driven by the following core objectives:

- Empower undergraduates with real-world industry knowledge, career guidance, and professional development insights across IT, Engineering, and Business domains.
- Facilitate meaningful connections between students and experienced mentors from both industry and academia, including international professionals.
- Enable cross-border mentoring experiences by welcoming international mentors and mentees through hybrid online participation.
- Create an immersive podcast-style mentoring experience that goes beyond passive lecture formats, emphasizing active interaction, Q&A, and peer engagement.
- Provide structured 1-on-1 mentoring opportunities after each in-person session, allowing personalized career guidance from industry experts.
- Broadcast sessions via YouTube Live to maximize outreach and create lasting educational content accessible to a wider IEEE community.
- Align fully with IEEE Mentoring Meet Program criteria for funding, reporting, and impact measurement.

3. Program Format & Delivery Model

3.1 Hybrid Mentoring Podcast Series

The program adopts a Hybrid Mentoring Podcast format — a structured, broadcast-style mentoring experience that combines the intimacy of in-person sessions with the global accessibility of virtual platforms. Each session is designed to feel like a professionally produced mentoring broadcast, enabling both physical attendees and online participants to engage meaningfully.

3.2 Session Structure

Each of the six sessions follows a consistent structure:

Time Slot	Activity	Duration

Opening	Welcome, icebreaker, session introduction by moderator	15 min
Mentor Panel	Structured mentoring discussions on domain topics (podcast format)	60 min
Open Q&A	Mentee questions to full panel; international mentees engage via platform	30 min
Networking Break	Informal interaction; virtual mentees in breakout rooms	15 min
1-on-1 Mentoring*	Dedicated one-to-one industry mentor time for mentees	120 min
Closing	Key takeaways, mentor reflections, closing remarks	20 min

** 1-on-1 Mentoring applies to Sessions 1–4 (hosted at industry partner premises only).*

3.3 Mentor Composition

Each session features three mentors drawn from two distinct sectors to ensure diversity of perspective:

- 2 Industry Mentors — senior practitioners from reputed organizations in the relevant domain.
- 1 Academic Mentor — a faculty member or researcher with domain expertise and academic leadership experience.

International mentors are specifically invited and integrated into every session via virtual participation platforms, satisfying the IEEE MM cross-border mentor diversity requirement.

3.4 Two-Tier Delivery Model

Episodes 1–4: Industry-Hosted In-Person + Virtual

Episodes 1 through 4 are hosted at the physical premises of domain-relevant Sri Lankan industry partner organizations. This immersive arrangement exposes mentees to real industry environments and workplace cultures directly relevant to each episode's domain. Mentees may attend physically (up to 40 per session) or join virtually via Zoom. International mentees are actively welcomed via the virtual channel throughout.

Following the formal mentoring session, each industry host facilitates a dedicated 2-hour 1-on-1 mentoring window. During this window, mentees can engage directly and personally with industry mentors for individualized career guidance, portfolio reviews, and professional advice in the host company's own environment.

Episodes 5–6: Studio-Based Hybrid Broadcast

The final two episodes adopt a full hybrid broadcast model, hosted from a professionally equipped studio facility with AR/VR technology and podcast-grade audio-visual infrastructure. Engineering domains — Mechanical and Electrical — are deliberately placed here because their academic and industry ecosystems are more globally distributed, making the broadcast format ideal for engaging international mentors and a wider IEEE community audience. These episodes are:

- Live-streamed on YouTube for broad public and IEEE community access.
- Simultaneously conducted via Zoom for structured virtual participation by local and international mentees.

- Hosted with 3 mentors per session: 2 virtual (online) mentors and 1 physically present mentor, keeping the format hybrid on both the mentor and mentee sides.

4. Episode Overview

The program is structured as six domain-specific Episodes under the StudPro Mentoring Podcast banner. Episodes 1–4 are hosted at Sri Lankan industry partner premises; Episodes 5–6 are delivered from a professional studio via hybrid broadcast.

Ep.	Domain	Format	Mentors	Mentees	Venue / Platform
1	AI, Data Science & Automation	Hybrid — Physical + Virtual	2 Industry + 1 Academic (1 Intl.)	40 (Physical + Virtual)	WSO2 / Axiata Digital Labs, Colombo
2	Telecom, Cloud & Network Infra.	Hybrid — Physical + Virtual	2 Industry + 1 Academic (1 Intl.)	40 (Physical + Virtual)	SLT-MOBITEL HQ / Dialog Axiata, Colombo
3	Cybersecurity & Digital Trust	Hybrid — Physical + Virtual	2 Industry + 1 Academic (1 Intl.)	40 (Physical + Virtual)	LSEG Technology / Pearson Lanka, Colombo
4	FinTech & Digital Banking	Hybrid — Physical + Virtual	2 Industry + 1 Academic (1 Intl.)	40 (Physical + Virtual)	IronOne Technologies / Nations Trust Bank Tech, Colombo
5	Mechanical Eng. & Smart Manufacturing	Studio Hybrid Broadcast	2 Online + 1 Physical (1 Intl.)	40 (Physical + Virtual)	AR/VR Studio | Zoom | YouTube Live
6	Electrical Eng. & Power Systems	Studio Hybrid Broadcast	2 Online + 1 Physical (1 Intl.)	40 (Physical + Virtual)	AR/VR Studio | Zoom | YouTube Live

Proposed industry partner venues are indicative and subject to confirmation. All four company-hosted venues are located in the Colombo tech corridor and represent domain-aligned leading organizations in Sri Lanka.

Episode 1 — Artificial Intelligence, Data Science & Automation

Format: Hybrid | Company-Hosted | Proposed Venue: WSO2 / Axiata Digital Labs, Colombo | Post-session: 2-hour 1-on-1 Mentoring

Academic Focus	AI fundamentals, data-driven decision making, ethical considerations in AI, and research directions in AI and automation.

Industry Focus	AI applications in products and services, automation in business processes, and workforce transformation driven by AI.

✔️ **Outcome:** Students gain insight into AI-related career opportunities and the practical skills needed beyond theoretical knowledge.

Rationale for Company Hosting: Sri Lanka has a rapidly growing AI and data engineering ecosystem anchored by organizations such as WSO2, Axiata Digital Labs, and Virtusa. Hosting at an AI-active tech company gives mentees direct exposure to live AI tools, data pipelines, and engineering culture.

Episode 2 — Telecommunications, Cloud & Network Infrastructure

Format: Hybrid | Company-Hosted | Proposed Venue: SLT-MOBITEL HQ / Dialog Axiata, Colombo | Post-session: 2-hour 1-on-1 Mentoring

Academic Focus	Networking principles, communication systems, cloud fundamentals, and curriculum relevance to modern connectivity standards.

Industry Focus	5G technologies, large-scale network operations, cloud infrastructure management, and future trends in telecommunications.

✔ **Outcome:** Students gain awareness of infrastructure-level careers and the technical skills required to operate and manage large-scale systems.

Rationale for Company Hosting: SLT-MOBITEL and Dialog Axiata are Sri Lanka’s premier telecommunications organizations, both with large-scale cloud and network operations infrastructure. Hosting at either facility gives mentees unparalleled visibility into enterprise network operations centers and telecommunications engineering environments.

Episode 3 — Cybersecurity & Digital Trust

Format: Hybrid | Company-Hosted | Proposed Venue: LSEG Technology / Pearson Lanka, Colombo | Post-session: 2-hour 1-on-1 Mentoring

Academic Focus	Cybersecurity fundamentals, threat modelling, risk management frameworks, and the role of cybersecurity education in modern engineering curricula.

Industry Focus	Real-world cyber threats, SOC operations, incident response procedures, and industry expectations for cybersecurity professionals.

✔ **Outcome:** Students gain clarity on cybersecurity career paths, required certifications, and the practical skill development needed to enter the field.

Rationale for Company Hosting: LSEG Technology (formerly London Stock Exchange Group) operates one of Sri Lanka’s most sophisticated cybersecurity operations from its Colombo hub, managing global financial data security. Companies like Pearson Lanka and hSenid also offer strong cybersecurity practices. Hosting in such an environment gives mentees direct insight into enterprise-grade security operations.

Episode 4 — FinTech & Digital Banking Technologies

Format: Hybrid | Company-Hosted | Proposed Venue: IronOne Technologies / Nations Trust Bank Digital Hub, Colombo | Post-session: 2-hour 1-on-1 Mentoring

Academic Focus	Financial information systems, data security in finance, and the academic foundations underpinning digital finance and payment systems.

Industry Focus	Digital payments, core banking systems, financial technology platforms, regulatory

	challenges in digital finance, and innovation in banking.

✔️ **Outcome:** Students understand how technology drives modern financial services and how software and systems engineers contribute to FinTech ecosystems.

Rationale for Company Hosting: IronOne Technologies is Sri Lanka's leading FinTech product company, powering digital banking platforms across Asia. Nations Trust Bank's digital technology division is equally prominent. Hosting in a FinTech environment allows mentees to observe live financial engineering products and understand how regulation, security, and innovation intersect.

Episode 5 — Mechanical Engineering & Smart Manufacturing

Format: Studio Hybrid Broadcast | AR/VR Studio + Zoom + YouTube Live | 2 Online Mentors + 1 Physical Mentor

Academic Focus	Core mechanical engineering principles, manufacturing processes, thermodynamics, materials science, and design methodologies taught in Sri Lankan universities.

Industry Focus	Automation in manufacturing, plant operations, predictive maintenance engineering, lean manufacturing, and the evolving role of mechanical engineers in smart factories.

✔️ **Outcome:** Students understand how traditional mechanical engineering knowledge is applied in modern, technology-driven industries and discover pathways into smart manufacturing careers.

Rationale for Studio Broadcast: Mechanical engineering and smart manufacturing expertise in Sri Lanka is distributed across state enterprises, export processing zones, and overseas. The studio broadcast format enables engagement with international manufacturing and industrial engineering experts who cannot travel to Sri Lanka, while still providing a high-quality, immersive experience for local mentees in the studio audience.

Episode 6 — Electrical Engineering & Power Systems

Format: Studio Hybrid Broadcast | AR/VR Studio + Zoom + YouTube Live | 2 Online Mentors + 1 Physical Mentor

Academic Focus	Electrical engineering theory, power systems analysis, renewable energy integration, power electronics, and academic research directions in energy systems.

Industry Focus	Power generation and distribution, renewable energy projects (solar, wind, hydro), smart grids, energy management systems, and industry challenges in Sri Lanka's energy sector.

✔️ **Outcome:** Students gain a comprehensive understanding of careers in electrical engineering and the energy sector, including how Sri Lanka's renewable energy transition creates new engineering opportunities.

Rationale for Studio Broadcast: Sri Lanka's power sector is undergoing significant transformation with large-scale renewable energy projects, many involving international partners and IEEE PES (Power & Energy Society) members. The studio broadcast format allows engagement with global power systems engineers and renewable energy researchers, providing students with an international perspective on an industry at a critical inflection point in Sri Lanka.

Closing Segment (All Episodes)

- Consolidated key takeaways from all mentors
- Mentee reflections and feedback collection (Official MM Feedback Form)
- Closing remarks and appreciation ceremony
- Short video testimonials captured from mentors and mentees for IEEE MM reporting

5. International Participation Framework

A defining feature of this program is its deliberate design for international inclusion, aligned with the IEEE Mentoring Meet cross-border participation objective. The following mechanisms are built into every session:

Participation Type	Mechanism
International Mentors	At least one mentor per session is sourced internationally and participates via Zoom or equivalent virtual platform.
International Mentees	Virtual seats are open globally; international mentees may register through the IEEE MM virtual participation link (https://forms.gle/jzAFKtUmtbYpbYUg7).
Virtual Q&A Integration	Dedicated time is allocated in every session for virtual participants to pose questions directly to the panel.
Zoom Breakout Rooms	Post-panel networking time includes breakout rooms for virtual mentees to engage informally with mentors.
YouTube Live Broadcast	Episodes 5 & 6 are broadcast live, enabling passive participation and wider IEEE community access globally.

6. Venue & Infrastructure

Episodes 1–4: Industry Partner Premises (Colombo Tech Corridor)

Each of the first four episodes is hosted at the premises of a domain-aligned Sri Lankan industry organization. The proposed host companies and rationale are:

Ep.	Domain	Proposed Host	Why This Venue
1	AI & Data Science	WSO2 / Axiata Digital Labs	Sri Lanka's leading open-source middleware and AI product engineering hubs; active AI and data platform development.
2	Telecom & Cloud	SLT-MOBITEL / Dialog Axiata	Sri Lanka's two largest telcos with on-site NOCs, cloud infrastructure, and 5G rollout engineering teams.
3	Cybersecurity	LSEG Technology / Pearson Lanka	Global financial and educational technology firms running enterprise-grade

			cybersecurity and SOC operations from Colombo.
4	FinTech & Banking	IronOne Technologies / Nations Trust Bank Digital Hub	Sri Lanka's premier FinTech product company and a leading digital banking innovator, both headquartered in Colombo.

- Each venue provides access to conference/meeting room facilities, audio-visual equipment, and networking space.
- The post-episode 2-hour 1-on-1 mentoring window uses the host company's open spaces and meeting rooms.
- Virtual participants connect via Zoom hosted by the organizing team throughout.

Episodes 5–6: Professional Studio Facility

- A professionally equipped studio with AR/VR capabilities and podcast-grade audio-visual infrastructure.
- YouTube Live stream setup for public broadcast to the global IEEE community.
- Zoom session running concurrently for structured virtual mentee participation.
- Physical studio audience maintained for local mentees alongside the virtual broadcast.

7. Mentee Engagement Strategy

Active mentee engagement is central to this program's design. The following strategies are employed:

- Pre-session mentee briefings to prepare relevant questions for the panel.
- Interactive podcast format encouraging real-time conversation rather than one-way presentations.
- Dedicated open Q&A time in every session.
- 1-on-1 mentoring slots (Episodes 1–4) for direct, personalized guidance.
- Virtual breakout rooms ensuring online mentees are not passive observers.
- Post-session feedback collection using the official IEEE MM Feedback Form.
- Mentee reflection segment at each session closing to consolidate learning.

8. Impact Metrics & KPIs

The following key performance indicators align with the IEEE Mentoring Meet Program measurement framework:

KPI	Target	MM Criterion
Total mentees (direct)	**240 (40 × 6)**	Participant numbers
Sessions delivered	**6 domain sessions**	Event scale
Mentors engaged	**18+ (3 per session)**	Mentor diversity
International mentors	**6+ (1 per session min.)**	Cross-border

International mentees	**Open / Unlimited (virtual)**	Cross-border
Mentor types represented	**Industry + Academia (both)**	Diversity
Feedback forms collected	**240 mentee responses**	Reporting
YouTube reach (Sessions 5–6)	**500+ views (target)**	Resource usage
1-on-1 mentoring sessions	**160+ interactions (S1–S4)**	Engagement depth

9. MM Program Compliance

This event proposal is fully structured to meet all IEEE Mentoring Meet Program requirements for funding, execution, and reporting:

- Mentee registration via official IEEE MM Mentee Registration Form.
- Mentor registration via official IEEE MM Mentor Registration Form.
- Post-event feedback collected using the official IEEE MM Feedback Form.
- Event reported on IEEE vTools with hashtags #mentoringmeet, #mm, #yp.
- Event photos and short video testimonials captured and uploaded to a shared Google Drive.
- Post-event report compiled and submitted through the official MM Reimbursement Form.
- Financial receipts (venue, refreshments, equipment, production) retained for reimbursement submission.
- Travel expenses excluded from the budget as per MM guidelines.

10. Program Highlights

IEEE StudPro 9.0 Mentoring Meet strongly emphasizes:

- Mentoring-driven learning: podcast-style interactive sessions rather than passive presentations.
- Active mentee engagement: structured Q&A, breakout rooms, and dedicated 1-on-1 time.
- International reach: cross-border mentors and mentees in every session.
- Real-world industry exposure: sessions hosted at partner company premises.
- Personalized guidance: 1-on-1 industry mentoring windows for 160+ interactions.
- Professional production: AR/VR studio setup and YouTube Live broadcast for final two sessions.
- Scalable impact: 240 direct mentee beneficiaries across 6 sessions.

11. Organizing Team

Lead Organizing Body: IEEE Young Professionals Sri Lanka (YPSL)
Co-Organizing Body: IEEE StudPro 9.0
MM Program Contact: mm.yp.ieee.org | #mentoringmeet

12. Useful Links & Resources

- IEEE Mentoring Meet Program: https://mm.yp.ieee.org
- Register Event: https://forms.gle/vd4zXLEAbnxeTK777
- Virtual Attendance: https://forms.gle/jzAFKtUmtbYpbYUg7
- Mentee Registration Form: https://forms.gle/ZeQgt47LgQupQY218
- Mentor Registration Form: https://forms.gle/5TJqDNqgA4FATiedA
- Event Feedback Form: https://forms.gle/jVjHN4ubFGA1ftxf9
- Reimbursement Form: https://forms.gle/7P7jHviBCjfKfLjT6
- Proposal Template: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1U9T0MDa1goeAtsSc8xbnvVahke-i_Umb/edit
- Event Report Template: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1cTHky2ysOI1ifga91UxbJFFRPANawggy/edit

Prepared by IEEE YPSL & IEEE StudPro 9.0 | Submitted under the IEEE YP Mentoring Meet Program

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